

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Human Values and Lessons from Leaders - Complete Topic Package

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Human Values and Lessons from Leaders

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1 Where values come from and how they become character | 2 Turning values into public-service choices |
| 3 Gandhi: keeping means and ends ethically connected | 4 Learning courage and calm from Indian exemplars |
| 5 Mahavir: many-sided truth and non-possession | 6 Kautilya and the design of corruption controls |
| 7 Duty without craving credit: Nishkama karma | 8 Reform through education: Savitribai Phule and Kalam |
| 9 How to use a leader without hero-worship | 10 Writing quotation answers that earn GS-IV marks |

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Human Values and Lessons from Leaders - Complete Topic Package

Subject: Ethics **Section:** Subject-wide Syllabus **Generation:** learner-v2:g1 **Ownership:** GS-IV Ethics topic; recent official-paper questions retain their exact year, paper and source note. **Source policy:** complete Basic owner first; solved practice before optional Advanced depth; consolidated register notes last.

CURRENT-AFFAIRS ANCHOR

Mission Karmayogi: values made role-relevant, not automatically internalised

- DoPT's NPCSCB focuses on functional and behavioural competencies.
- The approach addresses the citizen-government interface.
- Its stated orientation is a shift from rules to roles.
- iGOT is the learning platform in this capacity-building linkage.
- The Basic owner reports figures dated 6 February 2026: 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages.

Administrative link: Use it to show how value education can be embedded in role-based learning, behavioural practice and citizen-facing service design.

Limit: The figures demonstrate reach and completions, not ethical internalisation or a general APAR linkage. Do not invent an APAR linkage without a service-specific DoPT order.

Official source links:

- <https://dopt.gov.in/schemes/national-programme-civil-services-and-capacity-building-npcscb-mission-karmayogi>
- <https://igotkarmayogi.gov.in/>
- <https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2226246®=3&lang=1>

Source caution: Use the local Basic owner as the controlling source. Gandhi's 1925 list was published and endorsed by Gandhi but presented as sent by a correspondent; its original wording has 'pleasure' where ARC Box 2.8 prints 'leisure'. The 2024 Patel line, 2025 William James line, and 2025 Vivekananda law-morality line are UPSC attributions not traced to primary sources in the owner. Thiruvalluvar's 2025 wording is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623. Kalam used the righteousness-to-peace chain while crediting Sathya Sai Baba. Do not turn any caution into a fabricated citation.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

SESSION 1 - Where values come from and how they become character

Subject: Ethics | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-IV. **Core area:** Human values, their sources (family, society, education), and lessons from the lives/teachings of leaders, reformers and administrators. **Grounded in:** 2nd ARC, 4th Report *Ethics in Governance* (2007) - **Box 2.8** (Gandhi's Seven Social Sins, sourced by the ARC to *Young India*, 1925) and **Annexure-I(2)** (the Kautilya passages quoted in the National Colloquium speech of ARC Chairman M. Veerappa Moily, 1 September 2006); audited GS-IV PYQs (2024-2025 Mains, verbatim quotations of Vivekananda, Sardar Patel, Thiruvalluvar, William James, and the Mahavir question). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* advanced/02_Human-Values-and-Lessons-from-Leaders.md.

1. Visual foundation

SOURCES OF VALUES	->	VALUE	->	ADMINISTRATIVE TRANSLATION
Family (early conditioning)		Truth/Honesty		Accurate reporting, no fudging
Education/teachers		Compassion		Empathy in service delivery
Religion/culture		Courage		Whistleblowing, standing up to
pressure				
Personal role models/leaders		Self-discipline		Resisting temptation under
discretion				
Life experience/struggle		Duty (nishkama karma)		Devotion to task without craving
credit				

Core proposition: ANALYSIS: Values are not innate; they are transmitted through family, education, religion/culture and lived example, then tested and reaffirmed (or corroded) by institutional incentives - the same institutions-plus-values synthesis taught in 01.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
ANALYSIS: Values	Enduring beliefs about what is desirable/worthwhile, guiding choice across situations (contrast with 03 attitude, which is object-specific).
ANALYSIS: Value education	Deliberate cultivation of values through family, schooling and institutional training (e.g., foundation-course modules, Mission Karmayogi behavioural competencies).
ANALYSIS: Exemplar-based learning	Learning ethics through the lives of leaders/reformers rather than abstract rules alone - the method GS-IV quotation-questions test directly.
FACT: Nishkama karma	Bhagavad Gita's ideal of dutiful action without attachment to its fruit - a recurring Mains "duty and detachment" theme (2025 GS-IV Q5(a) quotation on devotion to duty).

SESSION 2 - Turning values into public-service choices

3. Leaders, teachings and their administrative lesson

Leader/thinker	Teaching (verbatim where tested)	Administrative lesson
FACT: Mahatma Gandhi	"Seven Social Sins" - ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the list and sources it to Gandhi in <i>Young India</i> , 1925: politics without principles; wealth without work; leisure without conscience; knowledge without character; commerce without morality; science without humanity; worship without sacrifice. ANALYSIS: The original <i>Young India</i> note of 22 October 1925 reads " pleasure without conscience" (the ARC's "leisure" is a variant), and Gandhi introduced the list as sent to him by a correspondent rather than composed by him	Warns against decoupling means from ethical restraint - power/knowledge/wealth must stay tied to conscience and character.
FACT: Swami Vivekananda	"Learn everything that is good from others, but bring it in, and in your own way absorb it; do not become others" (2024 GS-IV Q3(a) - traceable to <i>Complete Works</i> , Vol. III, "The Common Bases of Hinduism", Lahore, 1897). "The strength of a society is not in its laws, but in the morality of its people" (2025 GS-IV Q3(c) - ANALYSIS: set by UPSC as Vivekananda's, but not traceable to the <i>Complete Works</i> ; answer the idea, do not assert the provenance)	Selective, self-respecting learning from other systems; law is necessary but not sufficient - societal morality is the deeper safeguard.

Leader/thinker	Teaching (verbatim where tested)	Administrative lesson
FACT: Sardar Patel	"Faith is of no avail in the absence of strength. Faith and strength, both are essential to accomplish any great work" (2024 GS-IV Q3(b)) - ANALYSIS: no primary speech/letter source traced; treat as UPSC's attribution)	Conviction (values) must be paired with capacity/resolve to achieve results - echoes the values-plus-institutions synthesis.
FACT: Thiruvalluvar	"Those who in trouble untroubled are, will trouble trouble itself" (2025 GS-IV Q3(a)). ANALYSIS: This is a modern paraphrase, not a named historic translation, of Tirukkural 623 (Chapter 63, <i>Itukkan Aliyāmai</i> - not being distressed by adversity); G.U. Pope renders it "Who griefs confront with meek, ungrieving heart, / From them griefs, put to grief, depart"	Equanimity under adversity - a civil servant's composure itself defuses a crisis.
FACT: William James	"The greatest discovery of my generation is that a human being can alter his life by altering his attitudes" (2025 GS-IV Q3(b)). ANALYSIS: Widely attributed to James but not traceable to his writings; popularised by Norman Vincent Peale (1952). A genuine James line on the same theme: "Believe that life is worth living, and your belief will help create the fact" (1895)	Attitude is malleable and self-authored - links directly to 03 (attitude change).
FACT: Mahavir	Ahimsa (non-violence), Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya, Aparigraha (the five <i>Mahavratas</i>), with Anekantavada (many-sidedness of truth) and Syadvada (conditional predication) as the associated epistemological doctrines - tested in 2025 GS-IV Q4(b)	Anekantavada supports listening to multiple stakeholder viewpoints before deciding; Aparigraha cautions against accumulation/nepotism in office.
FACT: Kautilya	ARC Annexure-I(2) quotes the <i>Arthashastra</i> : "Just as it is not possible not to taste honey or poison placed on the surface of the tongue, even so it is not possible for one dealing with the money of the king not to taste the money in however small a quantity"; and "It is possible to know even the path of birds flying in the sky, but not the ways of officers moving with their intentions concealed" (Kangle's numbering: 2.9.32 and 2.9.34)	One of the earliest articulations that opportunity/discretion - not only character - breeds corruption; see 06 for full treatment.

SESSION 3 - Gandhi: keeping means and ends ethically connected

4. Indian applications and examples

- ANALYSIS: A district officer citing Vivekananda's "learn but do not become others" while adapting an e-governance model (from Estonia or Singapore) to local conditions rather than copying it wholesale.
- ANALYSIS: A civil servant applying Thiruvalluvar's equanimity teaching while managing a disaster response despite personal grief (the exact tension tested in the 2025 GS-IV Q7 case study on DC "Vijay").
- ANALYSIS: Gandhi's "commerce without morality" warning applied to a procurement officer resisting under-invoicing pressure from a favoured contractor.

SESSION 4 - Learning courage and calm from Indian exemplars

5. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: ARC **Box 2.8** reproduces Gandhi's Seven Social Sins and sources them to *Young India*, 1925, in this order: politics without principles; wealth without work; **leisure** without conscience; knowledge without character; commerce without morality; science without humanity; worship without sacrifice. ANALYSIS: The *Young India* note of **22 October 1925** (Collected Works, Vol. XXVIII) reads "**pleasure** without conscience", and Gandhi introduced the list as one his correspondent wanted readers to know - cite it as a list Gandhi published and endorsed, not one he is documented to have composed.
- FACT: Mahavir's five great vows (*Mahavratas*): Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya, Aparigraha; Anekantavada and Syadvada are the associated Jain doctrines of the many-sidedness of truth and conditional predication. ANALYSIS: Jain tradition contrasts Parshvanatha's four vows with Mahavir's five - brahmacharya is the vow Mahavir's tradition *separately enumerated*, having earlier been understood within aparigraha.
- FACT: Kautilya's *Arthashastra* is the classical Indian source the ARC quotes (Annexure-I(2)) for the structural, opportunity-driven - rather than purely moral - origin of official corruption.
- ANALYSIS: Value transmission channels commonly tested: family, school/teachers, religion, peer group, media, and direct exemplar/role-model learning.

SESSION 5 - Mahavir: many-sided truth and non-possession

6. UPSC traps

- WRONG: Quotation questions only test memorisation of the quote. -> They test your ability to translate the quote into a governance/administrative lesson relevant to "the present context" (the standard phrasing in 2024-2025 papers).
- WRONG: Values are fixed and unchangeable once formed. -> William James's own quoted teaching (2025 GS-IV Q3(b)) explicitly holds that attitudes/values can be altered by conscious effort.
- WRONG: Anekantavada means "no view is ever correct." -> It means truth is many-sided and no single perspective is complete - administratively, it supports multi-stakeholder consultation, not moral relativism or indecision.
- WRONG: Every quotation UPSC prints is an authenticated saying of the named thinker. -> The paper only proves UPSC's attribution. The Vivekananda "learn everything that is good" line (2024) is traceable to the *Complete Works*; the Sardar Patel line (2024), the William James line (2025) and the Vivekananda "strength of a society" line (2025) are **not** traceable to primary sources. Answer the idea in the "present context" - never invent a citation for the quotation.

SESSION 6 - Kautilya and the design of corruption controls

7. PYQ application

- FACT: 2024 GS-IV Q3(a)-(c): three verbatim quotations (Vivekananda, Sardar Patel, Kant) each required "what does it convey to you in the present context" - the standard exam format for this topic.
- FACT: 2025 GS-IV Q3(a)-(c): three verbatim quotations (Thiruvalluvar, William James, Vivekananda), same format.
- FACT: 2025 GS-IV Q4(b): "major teachings of Mahavir" and "their relevance in the contemporary world."
- FACT: 2025 GS-IV Q5(a): quotation on devotion to duty ("one who is devoted to one's duty attains highest perfection in life") analysed via "sense of responsibility and personal fulfilment."

SESSION 7 - Duty without craving credit: Nishkama karma

8. Mains angles

- ANALYSIS: Always structure a quotation answer as: (1) restate the core idea in one line, (2) explain the thinker's context briefly, (3) translate into a specific administrative/governance lesson, (4) give one concrete Indian example, (5) close with a one-line normative takeaway.
- ANALYSIS: Do not spend words on biography; examiners reward application, not history.

Answer thesis: A civil servant's values are inherited from family, education and culture, but made administratively usable only when consciously translated - through exemplars like Gandhi, Vivekananda, Kautilya and Mahavir - into specific standards of conduct under discretion and pressure.

SESSION 8 - Reform through education: Savitribai Phule and Kalam

8a. Additional routed leaders and quotations (historical demand)

Leader/thinker	Teaching (verbatim where verifiable)	Administrative lesson
FACT: Savitribai Phule	ANALYSIS: 2020 GS-IV Q5(a) (historical demand, routed here): "main factors responsible for gender inequality in India" and "contribution of Savitribai Phule" to remove it. FACT: Verified facts: with her husband Jyotirao Phule, she co-founded India's first girls' school at Bhide Wada, Pune, in 1848 , faced social hostility for teaching girls, and later worked on widow-remarriage support and against child-marriage and caste discrimination; conventionally regarded as India's first woman teacher/headmistress in the modern sense.	The single clearest administrative lesson: structural gender inequality (denial of education, child marriage, caste-linked exclusion) is corrected by <i>institution-building</i> (a school, a shelter, a support system), not appeals to sentiment alone - directly usable for any "measures to improve gender-specific challenges" question (see 04's 2024 GS-IV Q6(a) cross-link).
FACT: A.P.J. Abdul Kalam	ANALYSIS: 2019 GS-IV Q6(c) (historical demand, routed here): reflect on the saying "Where there is righteousness in the heart, there is beauty in the character. When there is beauty in the character, there is harmony in the home. When there is harmony in the home, there is order in the nation. When there is order in the nation, there is peace in the world." Attribution caution: Dr Kalam popularised this chain in speeches (e.g., his April 2007 address to the European Parliament) but explicitly credited it there to Sathya Sai Baba - treat it as a teaching Kalam <i>used and endorsed</i> , not one he composed.	The chain models a bottom-up theory of governance : individual integrity is the root cause of institutional and even international order - useful to open any answer on why personal ethics is not "merely private" but has systemic, even national-power, consequences (see 01's CNP section).
ANALYSIS: A.P.J. Abdul Kalam	2022 GS-IV Q3(b) (historical demand, routed here): reflect on a saying attributed to Kalam on building a corruption-free nation/society. ANALYSIS: Kalam spoke and wrote often on a "corruption-free India" (echoed in his book <i>Indomitable Spirit</i> and public addresses) as a function of youth empowerment, education and personal integrity multiplied across society; treat the precise wording as UPSC's own paraphrase unless the exact primary citation is separately verified.	Anti-corruption is framed as a bottom-up, education- and youth-driven social movement, not only a top-down enforcement problem - complements the ARC's institutions-plus-values synthesis (01) with a generational-change dimension.

Leader/thinker	Teaching (verbatim where verifiable)	Administrative lesson
ANALYSIS: Potter Stewart (US Supreme Court Justice)	2022 GS-IV Q3(a) (historical demand, routed here): reflect on the idea that "ethics is knowing the difference between what you have a right to do and what is right to do." Attribution caution: this line is almost universally attributed to Stewart in quotation compilations, but no primary judicial opinion, speech or writing has been traced containing it - answer the idea, and note it is "widely attributed to Potter Stewart," not confirmed to a primary source.	This is the clearest one-line statement of the legality-vs-ethics gap already taught via the ARC/Fulbright passage (10) - usable to open any answer distinguishing what is legally permissible from what is ethically right, with an Indian example (e.g., a lavish "gift" from a bidder that breaks no law but fails propriety, see 01).
ANALYSIS: Dalai Lama (Tenzin Gyatso)	2022 GS-IV Q3(c) (historical demand, routed here): reflect on a Dalai Lama saying connecting success and sacrifice. ANALYSIS: The most widely circulated matching quotation is "Judge your success by what you had to give up in order to get it" - treat as widely attributed public teaching rather than a primary-source-cited line.	Redefines administrative "success" away from pure output/target achievement toward what was <i>not</i> compromised (integrity, due process, colleagues' rights) to achieve it - a direct check against results-only performance evaluation.

UPSC trap: WRONG: A quotation question only needs the thinker's biography. -> As with the Section 6 quotation traps above, always convert the saying into a *named administrative mechanism* (a school built, a corruption driver named, a legality-ethics gap identified, a success metric redefined), not a biographical sketch.

8b. Comprehensive National Power - leader-exemplar angle (cross-link)

- ANALYSIS: For the full mechanism of how ethics/values strengthen each component of Comprehensive National Power (economic, military, socio-cultural/soft, technological, diplomatic) - the 2020 GS-IV Q1(a) historical demand - see 01_Ethics-and-Human-Interface.md, Section 11. This file's own contribution is the **leader-exemplar** register: a Gandhi, a Kalam or a Savitribai Phule each illustrate how one individual's value-driven conduct (Sarvodaya, corruption-free-nation advocacy, or institution-building for girls' education) compounds into the social-harmony and soft-power components of national strength specifically.

SESSION 9 - How to use a leader without hero-worship

9. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Match the thinker to the correct teaching (Gandhi's seven sins, Mahavir's vows, Kautilya's warning on discretion).

- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** "Learn everything that is good from others... do not become others." Explain this in the present context of civil service reform borrowing from global best practices.

- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** How do Mahavir's Anekantavada and Aparigraha remain relevant to a modern civil servant handling multi-stakeholder disputes and public resources?

SESSION 10 - Writing quotation answers that earn GS-IV marks

10. Executable directive decoding and answer architecture

Directive word	What is tested	Structural move
"What does it convey to you in the present context" (standard quotation format)	Application, not memorisation	Restate the idea in one line -> thinker's context in one line -> named administrative mechanism -> one Indian example -> one-line takeaway
Discuss / Reflect	Balanced multi-angle treatment	State the value/teaching -> 2 administrative applications -> one limitation/caution (e.g., an attribution caveat) -> conclusion
Explain / Illustrate	A precise mechanism with an example	Define -> mechanism -> one concrete Indian example doing the analytical work

10-mark architecture (~150 words): name the thinker/value precisely -> one-line context -> the specific administrative lesson (not a moral platitude) -> one Indian example -> one-line qualification (e.g., an attribution caution where relevant) -> conclusion.

Selectable evidence pool (pick 1-2, do not exhaust the list in one answer):

1. *Claim:* Values are transmitted, not innate. *Evidence:* Gandhi's Seven Social Sins (ARC Box 2.8). *Significance:* gives a checklist against which to test any policy/conduct. *Limitation:* the "leisure/pleasure" textual variance shows even canonical lists have transmission gaps.
2. *Claim:* Selective learning beats imitation. *Evidence:* Vivekananda's "learn... do not become others" (2024 GS-IV Q3(a)). *Significance:* supports adapting global e-governance models to local context. *Limitation:* over-applied, it can be used to resist legitimate reform.
3. *Claim:* Institution-building corrects structural inequality. *Evidence:* Savitribai Phule's Bhide Wada girls' school, 1848. *Significance:* models durable, structural correction over sentiment-only appeals. *Limitation:* one institution alone did not resolve 19th-century gender inequality - it required sustained, generation-spanning reform.
4. *Claim:* Personal integrity scales into national order. *Evidence:* Kalam's righteousness-to-peace chain (2019 GS-IV Q6(c), sourced by Kalam himself to Sathya Sai Baba). *Significance:* supports "why does individual ethics matter for national power" answers. *Limitation:* is a rhetorical chain, not an empirically demonstrated causal claim - flag it as illustrative, not proven.
5. *Claim:* Equanimity under adversity is administratively valuable. *Evidence:* Thiruvalluvar's Tirukkural 623 (2025 GS-IV Q3(a)). *Significance:* directly maps to composure in disaster/crisis leadership (see 05). *Limitation:* equanimity must not be read as passivity - decisive action is still required alongside composure.

Counterpoint and reasoned verdict (template): "This teaching is administratively valuable because [named mechanism], but its limitation is [X]; therefore it should be applied alongside [named institutional safeguard], not relied on alone."

11. Study links

- FACT: Advanced companion: advanced/02_Human-Values-and-Lessons-from-Leaders.md.
- FACT: 06_Indian-Moral-Thinkers-and-Philosophers.md - Kautilya, Gandhi, Vivekananda, Buddha in depth.
- FACT: 03_Attitude-Content-Structure-and-Persuasion.md - William James's attitude-change link.
- FACT: Philosophy/paper-1/indian/Jainism.md - Mahavir's philosophical system in full depth.
- FACT: 01_Ethics-and-Human-Interface.md - Comprehensive National Power mechanism in full.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024

- **Paper(s):** GS-IV
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Semantic table split - Year

- **Year:** 2024
- **Paper:** GS-IV
- **Q:** 2
- **PYQ demand (neutral rendering):** (a) belief in peace, not merely talk; (b) global warming and human greed
- **Directive / format:** Section A theory · 10 + 10 marks · 150 words each
- **Source status:** Routed to owning topic
- **Owner requirement:** Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
- **Year:** 2024
- **Paper:** GS-IV
- **Q:** 6
- **PYQ demand (neutral rendering):** (a) equal opportunity despite gender identity in Indian culture; (b) Mission Karmayogi
- **Directive / format:** Section A theory · 10 + 10 marks · 150 words each
- **Source status:** Routed to owning topic
- **Owner requirement:** Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- (a) belief in peace, not merely talk; (b) global warming and human greed
- (a) equal opportunity despite gender identity in Indian culture; (b) Mission Karmayogi

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-IV
- **Routed question demands:** 3

Semantic table split - Year

- **Year:** 2020
- **Paper:** GS-IV
- **Q:** 1
- **PYQ demand (neutral rendering):** (a) role of ethics and values in enhancing the three major components of Comprehensive National Power and social harmony; (b) education as pervasive tool for individual development and social transformation - NEP 2020
- **Directive / format:** Discuss / Examine · 10 + 10 marks · 150 words each
- **Source status:** Routed to owning Ethics topic; stem verified against official scan; OCR artifact resolved
- **Owner requirement:** Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
- **Year:** 2020

- **Paper:** GS-IV
- **Q:** 5
- **PYQ demand (neutral rendering):** (a) main factors for gender inequality in India and Savitribai Phule contribution; (b) internet expansion instilling cultural values in conflict with traditional values
- **Directive / format:** Discuss · 10 + 10 marks · 150 words each
- **Source status:** Routed to owning Ethics topic
- **Owner requirement:** Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
- **Year:** 2022
- **Paper:** GS-IV
- **Q:** 3
- **PYQ demand (neutral rendering):** (a) Potter Stewart on ethics vs right-to-do; (b) APJ Kalam on corruption-free nation; (c) Dalai Lama on success and sacrifice
- **Directive / format:** Discuss · 10 + 10 + 10 marks · 150 words each
- **Source status:** Routed to owning Ethics topic
- **Owner requirement:** Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- (a) role of ethics and values in enhancing the three major components of Comprehensive National Power and social harmony; (b) education as pervasive tool for individual development and social transformation - NEP 2020
- (a) main factors for gender inequality in India and Savitribai Phule contribution; (b) internet expansion instilling cultural values in conflict with traditional values
- (a) Potter Stewart on ethics vs right-to-do; (b) APJ Kalam on corruption-free nation; (c) Dalai Lama on success and sacrifice

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

A district training academy combines classroom ethics with supervisors who disclose conflicts and correct false field reports even when no audit is expected. Which explanation best captures why this can build integrity? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- B. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.
- C. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
- D. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.

Answer: A

Explanation: Value formation is social and revisable is the controlling principle. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 2

A recruit says that values learnt at home make later training irrelevant. Her mentor instead uses reflection, peer feedback and transparent work routines. Which view correctly distinguishes early conditioning from later internalisation? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
- B. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- C. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.
- D. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.

Answer: B

Explanation: Value formation is social and revisable is the controlling principle. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 3

An officer refuses a contractor's hospitality only during vigilance inspections but accepts it in private after the inspection team leaves. Is this best described as internalised probity or externally managed performance? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.
- B. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.
- C. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.
- D. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.

Answer: C

Explanation: Internalisation differs from performance is the controlling principle. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 4

A block officer corrects an overpayment before releasing funds although the error is unlikely to be detected and the correction delays the target. What feature most strongly indicates internalisation? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.
- B. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- C. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
- D. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.

Answer: D

Explanation: Internalisation differs from performance is the controlling principle. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 5

A trainee warmly supports a cleanliness campaign but falsifies attendance in an unrelated training programme. Which distinction explains why a positive campaign attitude alone does not establish honesty as a value? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
- B. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.
- C. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.
- D. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.

Answer: A

Explanation: Values are broader than attitudes is the controlling principle. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 6

A school evaluates students only by whether they can repeat slogans on integrity. What addition would better assess value education rather than temporary attitude display? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.
- B. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
- C. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.
- D. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.

Answer: B

Explanation: Values are broader than attitudes is the controlling principle. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 7

A department records every official's course completion on iGOT and declares corruption impossible. Which qualification follows from the distinction between competency exposure and ethical conduct under temptation? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.
- B. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- C. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.
- D. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.

Answer: C

Explanation: Mission Karmayogi is an institutional channel is the controlling principle. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 8

A service redesign maps roles at a citizen-facing office, identifies empathy and problem-solving gaps, and assigns relevant learning modules. Which Mission Karmayogi logic is being used? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- B. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.
- C. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
- D. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.

Answer: D

Explanation: Mission Karmayogi is an institutional channel is the controlling principle. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 9

A municipality meets its revenue target by pressuring small vendors to pay unofficial fees while publicising new parks. Which Gandhi-style diagnosis is most precise: failure of outcomes, or wealth and politics detached from ethical means? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
- B. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.
- C. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
- D. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.

Answer: A

Explanation: Gandhi's social sins join means to ends is the controlling principle. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 10

A research unit obtains useful health data by concealing consent conditions from participants. Which social-sin pairing most directly identifies the ethical failure? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
- B. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
- C. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.
- D. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.

Answer: B

Explanation: Gandhi's social sins join means to ends is the controlling principle. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 11

A candidate writes that Gandhi personally coined every word of a fixed seven-item list and quotes 'leisure' as the original wording. What correction preserves both exam utility and provenance? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
- B. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
- C. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.
- D. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.

Answer: C

Explanation: Gandhi list provenance needs care is the controlling principle. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 12

A civil-service ethics poster uses the ARC wording but footnotes it as a list Gandhi published and endorsed, noting the pleasure/leisure variation. Why is this preferable to treating a popular slogan as a settled primary text? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
- B. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.
- C. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
- D. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.

Answer: D

Explanation: Gandhi list provenance needs care is the controlling principle. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 13

A State copies a foreign digital grievance platform despite weak connectivity and language access in tribal blocks. A district team proposes local-language assisted kiosks while retaining transparent tracking. Which response best follows the teaching? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
- B. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
- C. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.
- D. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.

Answer: A

Explanation: Vivekananda supports adaptation, not imitation is the controlling principle. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 14

An official rejects every practice from another country because it is foreign. Why is this no more faithful to Vivekananda's proposition than mechanical transplantation? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.
- B. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
- C. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.
- D. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.

Answer: B

Explanation: Vivekananda supports adaptation, not imitation is the controlling principle. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 15

A flood-control officer sincerely believes in protecting vulnerable residents but neither prepares evacuation plans nor acts against an influential encroacher. What does the faith-and-strength proposition reveal about this failure? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
- B. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.
- C. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.
- D. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.

Answer: C

Explanation: Faith requires capacity and resolve is the controlling principle. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 16

A candidate assigns the exact quotation to a named Patel speech without evidence. What is the responsible way to retain the governance lesson while handling the attribution? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.
- B. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
- C. The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
- D. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.

Answer: D

Explanation: Faith requires capacity and resolve is the controlling principle. The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 17

During a landslide, a Sub-Divisional Magistrate remains calm, verifies road access, communicates uncertainty honestly and orders evacuation. Which element shows equanimity rather than emotional detachment? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
- B. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- C. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.
- D. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Thiruvalluvar teaches active equanimity** is the controlling principle. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 18

A supervisor tells an officer facing a communal rumour to wait silently because 'trouble troubles itself.' Which reading of the quotation is conceptually wrong? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.
- B. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
- C. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.
- D. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Thiruvalluvar teaches active equanimity** is the controlling principle. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 19

A probationer reframes a difficult rural posting as a chance to learn local administration, seeks feedback and improves service access. What valid insight about attitude change can be drawn without claiming the disputed wording is a James primary text? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.
- B. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
- C. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation.
- D. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.

Answer: C

Explanation: William James provenance and usable idea is the controlling principle. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 20

A coaching note cites the exact 2025 wording as a proved James discovery. What provenance correction should an examiner reward? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
- B. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.
- C. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.
- D. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation.

Answer: D

Explanation: William James provenance and usable idea is the controlling principle. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 21

A district reduces road deaths through fair enforcement, road engineering and local campaigns against drunk driving. Why would relying only on penalties or only on moral appeals both be incomplete? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.
- B. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.
- C. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- D. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Law needs social morality but not replacement** is the controlling principle. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 22

An officer excuses a procurement violation because her intention was good and morality matters more than rules. Which limit on the proposition defeats that reasoning? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- B. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.
- C. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.
- D. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Law needs social morality but not replacement** is the controlling principle. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 23

Before a land-acquisition decision, an officer hears cultivators, women workers, engineers and environmental experts, records reasons and chooses a lawful option. Which Jain-informed administrative discipline is illustrated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.
- B. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.
- C. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.
- D. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.

Answer: C

Explanation: Anekantavada is not moral relativism is the controlling principle. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 24

A chairperson refuses to decide a safety dispute because all viewpoints are equally true. Why is this an incorrect use of Anekantavada? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.
- B. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
- C. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation.
- D. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.

Answer: D

Explanation: Anekantavada is not moral relativism is the controlling principle. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 25

A licensing officer removes herself from a file involving her sibling's firm and records the conflict. Which public-service expression of Aparigraha is most direct? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- B. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation.
- C. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.
- D. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.

Answer: A

Explanation: Aparigraha translates into probity is the controlling principle. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 26

A hospital superintendent refuses to purchase essential equipment, claiming that avoiding all possession is ethically superior. What error confuses non-possessiveness with neglect of public duty? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.
- B. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- C. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.
- D. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.

Answer: B

Explanation: Aparigraha translates into probity is the controlling principle. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 27

A district finds that storekeepers can alter stock registers without independent reconciliation. It introduces separation of duties, random checks and transparent records. Which Kautilyan insight is being operationalised? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- B. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.
- C. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.
- D. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.

Answer: C

Explanation: Kautilya identifies opportunity and concealment is the controlling principle. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 28

A minister argues that only morally weak people need controls, so trusted officers should never be audited. Which part of Kautilya's reasoning challenges this view? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.
- B. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.
- C. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
- D. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.

Answer: D

Explanation: Kautilya identifies opportunity and concealment is the controlling principle. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 29

A department rotates all officers suddenly after an anonymous complaint, without recorded criteria or review. Why is this weaker than a transparent, risk-based rotation and integrity-support system? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.
- B. The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
- C. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation.
- D. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.

Answer: A

Explanation: **Kautilya is not surveillance alone** is the controlling principle. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 30

A procurement unit rewards accurate disclosure, protects reporters and conducts proportionate audits. Which balance distinguishes institutional vigilance from demoralising suspicion? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation.
- B. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.
- C. The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.
- D. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.

Answer: B

Explanation: **Kautilya is not surveillance alone** is the controlling principle. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 31

An officer completes a difficult vaccination drive, credits frontline workers and accepts that promotion may not follow, while tracking missed settlements. Why is this duty without attachment rather than indifference to results? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- B. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.
- C. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.
- D. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.

Answer: C

Explanation: Nishkama karma rejects personal attachment is the controlling principle. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 32

A colleague ignores repeated pension delays saying that one should not care about outcomes. Which conceptual distinction exposes the misuse of Nishkama karma? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.
- B. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- C. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case.
- D. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.

Answer: D

Explanation: Nishkama karma rejects personal attachment is the controlling principle. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 33

A revenue officer stays late to resolve pension grievances but documents workload risks, delegates lawfully and asks for staff support. How does this better express devotion to duty than heroic but unsustainable overwork? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- B. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case.
- C. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- D. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.

Answer: A

Explanation: Duty joins responsibility and fulfilment is the controlling principle. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 34

A superior orders an officer to suppress an inconvenient inspection report and calls obedience 'duty.' What boundary must a Nishkama karma answer state? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- B. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- C. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.
- D. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.

Answer: B

Explanation: Duty joins responsibility and fulfilment is the controlling principle. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 35

A district responds to girls' dropout by opening safe transport, recruiting local women educators and supporting adolescent re-entry rather than merely holding a ceremonial speech. Which Savitribai-inspired lesson is most accurately applied? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- B. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- C. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.
- D. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case.

Answer: C

Explanation: Savitribai Phule models institution-building is the controlling principle. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 36

A programme celebrates women achievers annually but leaves school toilets, safety and caste-linked exclusion unaddressed. What structural limitation does the Phule example reveal? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- B. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case.
- C. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- D. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.

Answer: D

Explanation: Savitribai Phule models institution-building is the controlling principle. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 37

A school programme combines integrity practice, respectful family dialogue and civic projects, while the district also improves complaint systems. Why is this stronger than claiming personal virtue alone automatically creates national order? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- B. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- C. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.
- D. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.

Answer: A

Explanation: Kalam's chain is attributed with care is the controlling principle. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 38

An answer calls the righteousness-to-peace chain Kalam's original theorem and treats it as statistical proof. Which two cautions are missing? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.
- B. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- C. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- D. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.

Answer: B

Explanation: Kalam's chain is attributed with care is the controlling principle. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 39

In a mining dispute, an officer invokes Gandhi's conscience but does not consult affected communities, apply law or assess environmental evidence. What makes the invocation ethically incomplete? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.
- B. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- C. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case.
- D. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.

Answer: C

Explanation: Exemplars need contextual translation is the controlling principle. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 40

A candidate uses Mahavir to justify consultation, then explains the statutory decision, recorded reasons and review process. Why is this better than biography-led answer writing? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- B. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- C. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.
- D. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case.

Answer: D

Explanation: Exemplars need contextual translation is the controlling principle. Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 41

For a quotation on courage, a candidate spends 120 of 150 words listing the leader's life events and gives no governance application. What central demand of the question remains unmet? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- B. Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.
- C. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- D. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.

Answer: A

Explanation: Quotation answers test translation is the controlling principle. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 42

Another candidate links courage to documented whistleblower protection, gives a district-level example and warns against reckless disclosure of personal data. Which answer architecture is demonstrated? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- B. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- C. Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.
- D. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.

Answer: B

Explanation: Quotation answers test translation is the controlling principle. A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 43

A department responds to procurement risk by conducting ethics discussions but retains opaque single-person approvals. What missing half of the values-plus-institutions approach remains? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.
- B. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.
- C. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.
- D. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.

Answer: C

Explanation: Values and institutions must work together is the controlling principle. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 44

Another department digitises every approval but rewards target completion even when field staff mislead citizens. Which ethical capability is still vulnerable despite stronger controls? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.
- B. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- C. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.
- D. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.

Answer: D

Explanation: Values and institutions must work together is the controlling principle. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 45

A matching question says Mahavir introduced ethical self-restraint for the first time by inventing Brahmacharya. Which precise correction follows from the tradition described in the owner? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.
- B. Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.
- C. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- D. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.

Answer: A

Explanation: Brahmacharya requires textual precision is the controlling principle. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 46

An administrator describes the five vows as a complete manual for replacing constitutional law. Which distinction between ethical teaching and public institutional duty is being ignored? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- B. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.
- C. The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.
- D. Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.

Answer: B

Explanation: Brahmacharya requires textual precision is the controlling principle. Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 47

A presentation claims that 7.26 crore completions establish that every official has become impartial. Which inference exceeds what the reported data can show? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.
- B. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- C. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.
- D. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.

Answer: C

Explanation: Competency scale is not conduct proof is the controlling principle. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

MCQ 48

A training director uses the figures to argue for multilingual access and then proposes observed behavioural practice and citizen feedback. Why is this a more defensible use of the data? Which source-grounded ethical principle most precisely explains the case?

- A. Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
- B. Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.
- C. Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
- D. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.

Answer: D

Explanation: Competency scale is not conduct proof is the controlling principle. As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct. The distractors are related propositions, but they do not identify the decisive mechanism in this case.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Solved PYQ 1 - 2024 - 10 marks

Question: Given below are three quotations of great thinkers. What do each of these quotations convey to you in the present context? (a) "Learn everything that is good from others, but bring it in, and in your own way absorb it, do not become others." -Swami Vivekananda (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2024 GS Paper-IV, Q3(a), verbatim English wording. The line is traceable to Complete Works, Vol. III, The Common Bases of Hinduism (Lahore, 1897).

Model solution

The quotation advocates discerning learning rather than imitation. It asks a society or civil servant to absorb useful knowledge through its own needs, constitutional values and social conditions. In administration, it means that reform should retain a tested principle while adapting its delivery, language and safeguards to Indian realities.

For example, a State may learn from a foreign digital grievance-redress model, but should provide assisted counters, local-language access, offline receipt options and an appeal route where connectivity or literacy is weak. The value is neither cultural isolation nor cosmetic localisation; it is informed adaptation that improves equal access and accountability.

The principle also disciplines public-service learning. An officer should study successful procurement, health or urban-service practices elsewhere, test their assumptions, consult affected groups and document why an adaptation fits the local context. Blind transplantation can exclude citizens; reflexive rejection can preserve avoidable inefficiency.

Thus, the present relevance of Vivekananda's thought is ethical self-respect joined to openness. Borrow what advances public welfare, but translate it through constitutional equality, citizen experience and verifiable results. That makes learning a responsible public act rather than imitation for prestige.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2024 - 10 marks

Question: Given below are three quotations of great thinkers. What do each of these quotations convey to you in the present context? (b) "Faith is of no avail in the absence of strength. Faith and strength, both are essential to accomplish any great work-" -Sardar Patel (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2024 GS Paper-IV, Q3(b), verbatim English wording. UPSC attribution retained; no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced in the Basic owner.

Model solution

The proposition conveys that moral conviction becomes socially useful only when joined to strength: competence, courage, organisation and perseverance. Faith supplies direction and legitimacy; strength turns that direction into effective action. A civil servant therefore needs both an ethical commitment to public welfare and the capacity to implement it fairly.

Consider disaster management. Sympathy for flood-affected families is inadequate without credible warnings, trained teams, accessible shelters, transparent relief lists and courage to act against unsafe encroachment. Conversely, administrative power without ethical purpose can become coercive or serve the influential. The public value lies in their combination.

In daily governance, this means preparing files carefully, mastering rules, communicating honestly and resisting improper pressure. A district officer who believes in girls' education must also build safe transport, coordinate schools and address exclusion. Good intentions without execution disappoint citizens; technical efficiency without conscience may deepen inequity.

There is an attribution caution: the quotation is set by UPSC as Sardar Patel's, but the Basic owner does not trace it to a primary speech or letter. That does not weaken its ethical idea. The sound verdict is that public service needs values to choose the right end and institutional capability to reach it lawfully.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2024 - 10 marks

Question: Given below are three quotations of great thinkers. What do each of these quotations convey to you in the present context? (c) "In law, a man is guilty when he violates the rights of others. In ethics, he is guilty if he only thinks of doing so." -Immanuel Kant (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2024 GS Paper-IV, Q3(c), verbatim English wording. This topic routes the demand as a legality-versus-ethics application.

Model solution

The quotation distinguishes external legality from the moral quality of intention. Law normally punishes an established violation of another's rights; ethics asks an earlier question: whether one is willing to treat another person merely as a means. In public office, this distinction encourages conscience before misconduct becomes an actionable wrong.

An officer may have discretion to accept lavish hospitality that escapes a narrowly framed rule. Even before any quid pro quo occurs, accepting it can impair impartiality and public trust. Similarly, a supervisor who plans to suppress an inconvenient inspection may not yet have falsified a record, but the intention already reveals disregard for citizens' entitlement to truthful administration.

This does not mean that the State should punish private thoughts. Due process, evidence and legality remain essential; administrative action cannot be based on speculative moral policing. The practical translation is preventive ethics: disclose conflicts, recuse where necessary, maintain reasoned records and use codes and training to interrupt harmful intent before it becomes conduct.

Thus, the quotation expands responsibility beyond fear of punishment. A civil servant should ask not only, 'Can I do this legally?' but also, 'Can I justify it as respectful, impartial and fair to those affected?' That inner test strengthens, rather than replaces, lawful accountability.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2025 - 10 marks

Question: Given below are three quotations of great thinkers. What do each of these quotations convey to you in the present context? 3-(a) "Those who in trouble untroubled are, Will trouble trouble itself." - Thiruvalluvar (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2025 GS Paper 4, Q3(a), verbatim English wording. The Basic owner treats it as a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623, not a named historic translation.

Model solution

The quotation conveys equanimity under adversity. A calm mind does not deny danger; it prevents fear, anger and confusion from multiplying the original problem. For a civil servant, composure is therefore an operational virtue because it permits accurate assessment, humane communication and timely action in a crisis.

During a landslide or communal rumour, an officer should verify facts, activate response teams, communicate what is known and unknown, protect vulnerable groups and record decisions. Panic can spread misinformation and favour arbitrary action; disciplined calm helps the administration coordinate police, health workers and local representatives. The lesson is visible in a district control room that prioritises verified warnings and evacuation over dramatic but unsupported announcements.

Equanimity has a boundary. It is not passivity, emotional coldness or delay disguised as patience. A collector who remains serene while failing to order rescue, hear grievances or correct an error has misunderstood the teaching. Compassionate urgency must accompany inner steadiness.

The wording should also be handled carefully: it is a modern paraphrase linked by the Basic owner to Tirukkural 623, whose theme is not being distressed by adversity. The reasoned verdict is that calm leadership makes trouble manageable when it is joined to evidence, decisive lawful action and empathy.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2025 - 10 marks

Question: Given below are three quotations of great thinkers. What do each of these quotations convey to you in the present context? 3-(b) "The greatest discovery of my generation is that a human being can alter his life by altering his attitudes." - William James (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2025 GS Paper 4, Q3(b), verbatim English wording. Widely attributed to William James but not traceable to his writings; popularised by Norman Vincent Peale (1952).

Model solution

The idea conveys that attitudes are not wholly fixed: conscious reflection, learning and repeated practice can change how a person interprets difficulty and therefore how that person acts. In public service, this matters because an officer's attitude toward citizens, marginalised groups and unfamiliar postings shapes the quality of discretionary service.

A probationer initially treating a remote posting as punishment may, through field immersion and feedback, recognise local knowledge, learn the language and redesign access to welfare services. The changed attitude does not alter material constraints by wish alone; it changes attention, effort and willingness to collaborate. Training, mentoring and transparent work routines can therefore support behavioural competence alongside technical skill.

The proposition must not become victim-blaming. Poverty, discrimination, administrative opacity and inadequate staffing cannot be solved by asking citizens or employees merely to think positively. Structural reform, lawful entitlements and institutional accountability remain indispensable.

There is also a provenance caution. The exact sentence is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings in the Basic owner; it was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale. The answer should analyse the proposition, not invent a James citation. The verdict is that reflective attitude change is a real ethical resource when paired with fair institutions and concrete action.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2025 - 10 marks

Question: Given below are three quotations of great thinkers. What do each of these quotations convey to you in the present context? 3- (c) "The strength of a society is not in its laws, but in the morality of its people." - Swami Vivekananda (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2025 GS Paper 4, Q3(c), verbatim English wording. UPSC attribution retained; the wording is not traceable to Vivekananda's Complete Works in the Basic owner.

Model solution

The proposition highlights that law works best when citizens and officials possess internalised morality. No police force or rule book can observe every transaction, road crossing or exercise of discretion. Honesty, empathy and civic responsibility therefore reduce the gap between formal compliance and lived public order.

For instance, road safety improves not only through penalties but when drivers refuse drunk driving, communities discourage unsafe conduct and enforcement remains impartial. Likewise, welfare delivery depends on officials who do not demand informal payments and citizens who do not fabricate claims. Such everyday morality preserves trust and lowers the cost of enforcement.

However, morality cannot replace law. Social majorities can hold prejudices, and good intentions may be disputed. Constitutional rights, due process, transparent procedures and independent review protect persons precisely when informal morality fails. A procurement officer cannot ignore conflict-of-interest rules by asserting a moral purpose.

The exact line should be treated as a 2025 UPSC attribution, not as a verified primary Vivekananda quotation; the nearest documented theme in the owner is his concern that many laws may be little regarded. The balanced verdict is that ethical citizenship gives law its social strength, while just institutions channel morality, protect minorities and hold power accountable.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2025 - 10 marks

Question: What are the major teachings of Mahavir? Explain their relevance in the contemporary world. (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2025 GS Paper 4, Q4(b), verbatim English wording.

Model solution

Mahavir's major teachings include the five Mahavratas: Ahimsa (non-violence), Satya (truthfulness), Asteya (non-stealing), Brahmacharya (self-restraint) and Aparigraha (non-possessiveness). Jain thought also develops Anekantavada, the many-sidedness of truth, and Syadvada, conditional predication. Together they cultivate restraint, truth, non-harm and humility in judgement.

Their contemporary relevance is practical. Ahimsa supports non-violent conflict resolution and humane treatment of vulnerable persons. Satya and Asteya strengthen honest records and resistance to misuse of public resources. Aparigraha provides an ethical basis for conflict-of-interest disclosure, anti-nepotism and non-attachment to office-derived gain. Before land acquisition or environmental clearance, Anekantavada supports serious consultation with cultivators, workers, experts and affected communities; it improves knowledge and legitimacy.

Yet many-sidedness is not moral relativism. A public authority must eventually decide on lawful evidence and record reasons; it cannot say that every claim is equally valid. Nor can personal restraint substitute for rights, rules and enforcement. Brahmacharya should be described carefully as separately enumerated in Mahavir's tradition, not casually as an idea he demonstrably invented.

Therefore, Mahavir's teaching remains relevant as an ethical discipline for plural societies: listen widely, harm less, speak truthfully and restrain private gain, while acting through constitutional institutions.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2025 - 10 marks

Question: "One who is devoted to one's duty attains highest perfection in life." Analyse this statement with reference to sense of responsibility and personal fulfilment as a civil servant. (Answer in 150 words)

Source / ownership: Official local 2025 GS Paper 4, Q5(a), verbatim English wording.

Model solution

The statement reflects Nishkama karma: duty is performed with full commitment but without attachment to personal reward, credit or promotion. For a civil servant, responsibility means timely, competent and fair action because citizens depend on the office, not because recognition is assured. Personal fulfilment follows from meaningful service and integrity, rather than from status alone.

In a pension camp, devotion to duty would mean identifying delayed cases, correcting records, communicating reasons and ensuring that elderly claimants are not forced through avoidable visits. The officer may share credit with frontline staff and still measure whether the service actually reached people. This is not indifference to results; it is non-attachment to private gain combined with rigorous concern for public outcomes.

Duty has ethical limits. It does not require obeying an unlawful order, accepting chronic overwork as virtue or disregarding affected citizens in the name of efficiency. A responsible officer records dissent where necessary, seeks lawful support and protects both service quality and staff welfare.

Mission Karmayogi's focus on functional and behavioural competencies offers an institutional setting in which such responsibility can be practised, but course completion alone cannot demonstrate character. The verdict is that devoted duty unites inner fulfilment with accountable public action when it is guided by legality, empathy and measurable citizen welfare.

Why this earns marks: It states the governing ethical idea, translates it into public administration, uses a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a limit, and ends with a reasoned verdict.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain how family, educational institutions and public-service training can move a value from social instruction to internalised administrative conduct. Answer in 150 words. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

A value becomes internalised when it guides conduct even without surveillance. Family supplies early modelling: honesty in small transactions and respect for others make moral language concrete. Schools deepen it through discussion, fair rules, service learning and teachers whose conduct matches instruction. Public-service training must then test the value under real discretion.

For example, a trainee may learn compassion through community immersion, practise it by redesigning a disability-access counter, and receive feedback from citizens rather than merely memorising a definition. Mission Karmayogi can support such development through functional and behavioural competencies, role-based learning and iGOT access.

However, lectures and course completions do not prove integrity. Opaque targets, political pressure and reward for only numerical output can corrode a value. Training should be reinforced by transparent procedures, mentoring, reasoned records and safe reporting channels.

Thus, inculcation is a continuing social and institutional process: example begins it, practice tests it, and accountable work culture makes it durable.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Gandhi's Seven Social Sins are more useful as a diagnostic of ethical means than as a complete governance programme. Discuss. Answer in 150 words. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Gandhi's published-and-endorsed list identifies moral decoupling: politics from principle, wealth from work, commerce from morality, knowledge from character and similar separations. It is a sharp diagnostic because it asks whether an attractive outcome has been pursued through exploitative, deceptive or dehumanising means.

A procurement office may deliver a project on time yet tolerate collusive bidding. The list exposes why target achievement cannot cleanse an unfair process. Likewise, science without humanity cautions a health-data project that obtains useful information without meaningful consent.

Its limitation is institutional. A moral warning does not specify audit design, appeal procedures, sanctions or protection for an honest official. The ARC's textual context also warrants care: the 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent, and 'pleasure' appears where ARC prints 'leisure.'

Therefore, the list should guide ethical scrutiny, while codes, transparency, conflict-of-interest rules and citizen oversight supply enforceable governance. Character identifies the wrong; institutions help prevent and correct it.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Compare Gandhi's character-centred warning with Kautilya's opportunity-centred account of corruption. What balanced vigilance design follows for a district administration? Answer in 200 words. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Gandhi and Kautilya illuminate different but complementary causes of corruption. Gandhi's Seven Social Sins warn that wealth, politics and commerce become corrupt when detached from conscience, work, principle and morality. His lens asks whether the actor has internalised ethical restraint. Kautilya's honey and fish analogies, quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2), begin from a harder administrative fact: officials handling public money face temptation and concealment, so character cannot be the sole safeguard.

A balanced district design should therefore combine moral formation with opportunity reduction. Induction and mentoring can discuss integrity, citizen dignity and conflicts of interest. Simultaneously, the administration should separate sanction, payment and verification roles; reconcile stock and beneficiary records; publish criteria; conduct proportionate risk-based audits; and preserve appeal and whistleblower channels. Honest performance should receive recognition and lawful continuity, reflecting Kautilya's positive element, while wrongful accumulation should be investigated through due process.

Neither pole is sufficient. Gandhi alone can become a sermon that ignores opaque incentives. Kautilya alone can become indiscriminate suspicion, punitive transfers and demoralisation of honest staff. Rotation without objective criteria is not vigilance.

The reasoned conclusion is values plus institutions: cultivate conscience for unobserved choices, but design transparent systems because even good people should not be asked to resist avoidable temptation alone.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: How can Anekantavada and Aparigraha improve a civil servant's handling of a contested development project without producing indecision or anti-development romanticism? Answer in 200 words. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Anekantavada teaches that a complex truth-claim has multiple standpoints; Aparigraha teaches non-possessiveness and restraint toward private gain. Together they can improve development administration by making consultation substantive and decision-making less vulnerable to capture.

In a contested renewable-energy or road project, Anekantavada requires the officer to hear landholders, women workers, Scheduled Tribe representatives, engineers, environmental experts and local bodies. The officer should disclose the evidence, distinguish facts from fears, consider alternatives and record reasons for the selected option. This is not a veto for every interest; it is epistemic humility before a lawful, timely decision.

Aparigraha adds a probity discipline. The officer must disclose relationships with bidders, recuse from conflicted files, reject gifts and ensure that compensation or rehabilitation decisions are not distorted by family, political or commercial gain. It directs attention from possession to trusteeship of public power.

The limits matter. Many-sidedness is not relativism: safety norms, rights and statutory mandates set non-negotiable boundaries. Non-possession is not refusal to build infrastructure or spend public funds; neglecting a needed project can also harm citizens.

Hence, Jain ethics supports development that is evidence-led, participatory and conflict-of-interest-free. Its mature administrative translation is a reasoned decision with safeguards, not endless consultation or moral display.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Leader-based ethics can humanise public administration, but it can also obscure institutional responsibility. Critically examine with reference to Gandhi, Vivekananda, Savitribai Phule and A.P.J. Abdul Kalam. Answer in 250 words. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Leader-based ethics humanises administration by converting abstract values into memorable moral tests. Gandhi's Seven Social Sins warn an officer against commerce without morality or politics without principle; they make means as important as targets. Vivekananda's traceable 2024 teaching on learning from others without becoming them supports contextual adaptation rather than borrowed prestige. Savitribai Phule's 1848 Bhide Wada girls' school demonstrates that equality requires institution-building, not sympathetic rhetoric. Kalam's popularly used righteousness-to-peace chain encourages an officer to see personal integrity as socially consequential.

These lessons can improve public service. A district adapting an e-governance platform should retain transparency but add local-language and assisted access. A girls' education plan should move beyond celebration to safe transport, teachers and re-entry support. An officer confronted by a gift from a bidder can use Gandhi's means-ends test before any formal violation occurs.

However, exemplary names are not a substitute for constitutional design. Gandhi's list does not specify audit trails or appeal systems. Kalam's chain is an aspiration, not proof that private virtue alone causes national order; moreover, he credited it to Sathya Sai Baba in a 2007 European Parliament address. The 2025 Vivekananda law-and-morality wording is not traceable to the Complete Works, so an answer must analyse the idea rather than invent provenance. Hero worship can silence affected voices, reduce a dilemma to biography, or excuse officials who profess noble motives while breaching procedure.

The proper method is translation: state the teaching, identify a decision rule, use an Indian illustration, and add institutional safeguards. The verdict is qualified: exemplars make ethical imagination vivid, but accountable governance needs transparent rules, evidence, participation and remedies alongside character.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Evaluate Mission Karmayogi as an institutional bridge between human values and citizen-centred public service. What can it enable, and what must not be claimed from it? Answer in 250 words. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Mission Karmayogi, under the National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building, is relevant to human values because it shifts capacity-building attention from a narrow rules orientation toward roles, competencies and the citizen-government interface. DoPT's NPCSCB framework includes functional and behavioural competencies, while iGOT provides a learning platform. This creates an institutional route through which empathy, integrity, problem-solving and duty can be practised alongside technical capability.

Its promise is visible at the service-delivery level. A role-based module can help a citizen-facing official recognise accessibility barriers, communicate reasons for a decision, manage conflict and use a grievance system responsibly. Learning may be connected to mentoring, field reflection and redesign of a pension, health or land-service workflow. The Basic owner reports figures dated 6 February 2026: 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages. These facts demonstrate reach and multilingual availability.

But reach is not internalisation. A completed course does not prove that an officer will resist a conflicted contractor, treat a claimant with dignity or report an improper order. Behaviour can be performed for a dashboard. Nor should an answer invent a general APAR linkage: the owner expressly says not to claim one without a service-specific DoPT order.

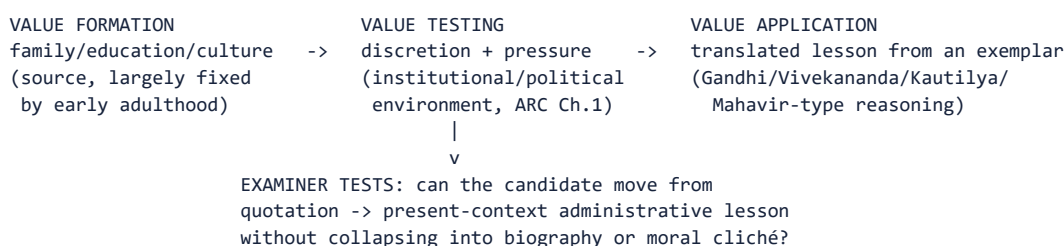
Mission Karmayogi should therefore be supplemented by fair workload design, transparent discretion, citizen feedback, ethical leadership, conflict-of-interest safeguards and due-process accountability. Its achievement is to make values learnable and role-relevant; its limit is that character and culture are tested in real choices. The reasoned verdict is that it is a valuable bridge, not a certificate of ethical governance in every service setting.

Why this earns marks: The response defines the issue, develops the relevant mechanism with India-centric evidence, tests a limitation, and gives a mark-scaled conclusion.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Ethics | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-IV. **Core area:** Human values, their sources, and administrative lessons from leaders/reformers. **Grounded in:** 2nd ARC, 4th Report *Ethics in Governance* (2007) - **Box 2.8** (Gandhi's Seven Social Sins) and **Annexure-I(2)** (Kautilya passages in the ARC Chairman's National Colloquium speech, 1 September 2006); audited GS-IV PYQs (2024-2025 Mains, verbatim quotations). **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* basic/02_Human-Values-and-Lessons-from-Leaders.md.

1. Architecture



Analytical claim: GS-IV's leader/quotation questions are not history questions; they are **applied-ethics translation tests** - the examiner rewards candidates who can derive a specific, defensible administrative rule from a general moral teaching, then bound that rule with a realistic limitation.

2. Concepts and distinctions

Concept	Precise meaning
ANALYSIS: Value internalisation vs value performance	Internalisation = value genuinely shapes private choice even unobserved; performance = value displayed only for external audit/appraisal - the ethical-dilemma literature treats only the former as robust under pressure.
FACT: Nishkama karma (Gita)	Duty performed without attachment to result - repeatedly tested via "devotion to duty" quotations (2025 GS-IV Q5(a)).
FACT: Anekantavada / Syadvada (Mahavir)	Doctrine of many-sidedness of truth and conditional predication - supports epistemic humility in policy-making, not relativism about right and wrong.
ANALYSIS: Exemplar fallacy	The risk of citing a leader's life uncritically as if perfect virtue automatically resolves a complex institutional dilemma - advanced answers must show <i>where</i> the exemplar's principle has limits.

3. Detailed treatment of frequently tested leaders

Gandhi's Seven Social Sins - deeper reading

- FACT: Reproduced in ARC **Box 2.8** and sourced there to Gandhi in *Young India*, 1925 - a prescient warning against decoupling ends (wealth, pleasure, knowledge, politics, commerce, worship) from ethical means (work, conscience, humanity, character, principle, morality, sacrifice).
- ANALYSIS: Provenance nuance worth one line in an answer: in the *Young India* note of 22 October 1925 Gandhi presented the list as one his correspondent wanted readers to know; the ARC's Box also prints "leisure without conscience" where the original reads "pleasure without conscience". Cite it as a list Gandhi published and endorsed.
- ANALYSIS: Administrative reading: each "sin" names a **means-ends decoupling** - e.g., "politics without principles" anticipates exactly the ARC's later (1.12) diagnosis that corrupt political markets displace rather than eliminate corruption.
- ANALYSIS: Limitation: as a list of prohibitions it does not itself supply an enforcement mechanism - it must be paired with institutional design (Nolan-type codes, 09/16), consistent with the "values need institutions" synthesis in 01.

Vivekananda's two tested quotations - synthesis

- FACT: "Learn everything that is good from others, but bring it in, and in your own way absorb it; do not become others" (2024) is traceable to the *Complete Works*, Vol. III, "The Common Bases of Hinduism" (Lahore, 1897).
- ANALYSIS: "The strength of a society is not in its laws, but in the morality of its people" (2025) is set by UPSC as Vivekananda's but is **not traceable** to the *Complete Works*. The nearest documented statement of the theme is from "Our Duty to the Masses" (23 June 1894): "No country on earth has so many laws, and in no country are they so little regarded." Answer the proposition; do not manufacture a citation.
- ANALYSIS: Read together they still form a coherent position: **selective institutional borrowing plus primacy of internalised societal morality over external law**.
- ANALYSIS: Advanced application: when India adapts a foreign anti-corruption model (Hong Kong's ICAC, Singapore's CPIB - see 23), Vivekananda's principle argues for adaptation to Indian federal, political and cultural conditions rather than transplant - a caution directly relevant to why the Lokpal took decades longer to operationalise than the ARC's 2007 recommendation envisaged.

Kautilya - the earliest structural (not moral) theory of corruption

- FACT: Quoted in ARC **Annexure-I(2)** (National Colloquium speech of ARC Chairman M. Veerappa Moily,

1 September 2006), which reproduces five *Arthashastra* propositions: officials handling the king's money can no more avoid tasting it than a tongue can avoid tasting honey or poison (Kangle 2.9.32); embezzlement is as unobservable as a fish drinking water (2.9.33); "it is possible to know even the path of birds flying in the sky, but not the ways of officers moving with their intentions concealed" (2.9.34); those who have amassed money wrongfully should be made to disgorge it and be moved to other work; and those who increase the king's wealth "in just ways" should be made permanent in their offices.

- ANALYSIS: This is a **structural/opportunity theory** of corruption predating modern institutional economics by roughly two millennia - the prescribed remedy (positive permanence for the honest, disgorgement and reassignment for the rest) anticipates today's performance-linked, rotation-based vigilance mechanisms (see 21).

- ANALYSIS: Advanced distinction: Kautilya's realism (assume temptation is near-universal; design controls accordingly) sits in productive tension with Gandhi's character-based idealism - a strong Mains answer can use *both* registers depending on the question's framing (systemic design vs personal conduct).

Mahavir - Anekantavada as an administrative epistemology

- FACT: 2025 GS-IV Q4(b) tested "major teachings of Mahavir" and their "relevance in the contemporary world" - Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya, Aparigraha (five *Mahavratas*), plus Anekantavada and Syadvada.

- ANALYSIS: Precision point worth one line: Jain tradition contrasts Parshvanatha's four restraints with Mahavir's five. Brahmacharya is best described as the vow Mahavir's tradition *separately enumerated*, having earlier been understood as included within aparigraha - not as an ethical idea Mahavir is documented to have invented.

- ANALYSIS: Administrative translation: Anekantavada supports structured multi-stakeholder consultation (e.g., before a land-acquisition or environmental-clearance decision) as an epistemic discipline, not mere procedural box-ticking - it says complex public decisions are irreducibly many-sided.

- ANALYSIS: Aparigraha (non-possessiveness) maps onto conflict-of-interest and anti-nepotism norms in public office - an official's "non-attachment" to personal gain from office is the ethical core of probity (see 14).

4. Institutional translation of value-education

- CURRENT: Mission Karmayogi / the National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building (NPCSCB), approved by the Union Cabinet on **2 September 2020**, builds behavioural competencies (values, attitude, integrity) into training through the **FRAC** approach (Framework of Roles, Activities and Competencies) and the **iGOT-Karmayogi** platform, with the **Capacity Building Commission** established on **1 April 2021**. Official scale, as reported to Parliament with data as on **6 February 2026**: over 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore course completions and 23 languages. Do not assert a general APAR/appraisal linkage without a service-specific DoPT order.

- ANALYSIS: Value-education in Mains answers should therefore reference *both* the classical exemplar and the current institutional delivery mechanism, showing the values-plus-institutions synthesis in practice.

5. Indian applications and boundary cases

- ANALYSIS: A civil servant applying Vivekananda's selective-borrowing principle while localising a Bhoomi/Gyandoot-style e-governance model (see 23) for a state with weaker digital literacy - the limitation is that "adaptation" must not become an excuse to dilute the reform's substance.

- ANALYSIS: A civil servant applying Kautilya's rotation/reward logic through a transparent, rule-bound transfer policy (see 21) rather than ad hoc reassignment - the boundary is that rotation itself can be misused as a punitive tool if not rule-bound.

6. Limitations and trade-offs

- ANALYSIS: Exemplar-based reasoning risks selective quotation - a leader's teaching can be invoked to justify opposite administrative choices unless the specific institutional context is stated.
- ANALYSIS: Kautilya's assume-everyone-is-tempted realism, if taken alone, can justify excessive, demoralising surveillance of honest officials (see 21 for the ARC's explicit caution against this over-correction).
- ANALYSIS: Gandhi's character-first idealism, if taken alone, under-weights the ARC's own institutional diagnosis (01) that discretion and monopoly - not character alone - drive corruption.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- FACT: The "Seven Social Sins" list appears in the 4th Report as **Box 2.8**, sourced there to Gandhi in *Young India*, 1925 (original note dated 22 October 1925, Collected Works Vol. XXVIII).
- FACT: Mahavir's five Mahavratas: Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya, Aparigraha.
- FACT: Anekantavada and Syadvada are Jain doctrines of the many-sidedness and conditional predication of truth (*syat* = "in some respect / from a standpoint"), distinct from moral relativism.
- FACT: The Kautilya passages the ARC quotes are from the *Arthashastra*'s chapter on inspecting the work of officers - Kangle's numbering 2.9.32-34.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- WRONG: Anekantavada is a form of ethical relativism ("nothing is really right or wrong"). -> It is an epistemological doctrine about the complexity of truth-claims, not a denial of moral standards.
- WRONG: Kautilya's Arthashastra advocates unrestrained state surveillance of all officials as a first resort. -> His remedy pairs vigilance with positive incentives (permanence in office, rewards) for officials who serve with integrity - a balanced, not purely punitive, design.
- WRONG: Nishkama karma means indifference to outcomes/results in public service. -> It means non-attachment to personal credit/reward for the outcome, not indifference to whether the public duty is performed well.

9. Current application

Current application (verify before use)	Topic-specific analytical use
CURRENT: Mission Karmayogi/NPCSCB uses the iGOT-Karmayogi platform and the FRAC competency framework for civil-service learning (Cabinet approval 2 September 2020; Capacity Building Commission from 1 April 2021)	Shows an institutional channel through which value lessons can be translated into training; cite the 6 February 2026 parliamentary figures rather than undated claims, and do not claim a general APAR linkage without an exact DoPT order and scope.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- FACT: 2025 GS-IV Q4(b) (Mahavir) and Q5(a) (devotion to duty) together test whether a candidate can move from a classical/religious teaching to a specific *contemporary* administrative relevance claim, exactly the translation exercise emphasised in this file.
- ANALYSIS: Where a quotation question pairs two thinkers implicitly (e.g., Vivekananda's law-vs-morality claim alongside a code-of-conduct question), an advanced answer should explicitly connect the two registers rather than answering them in isolation.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: Leader-based teachings function in GS-IV as *compressed ethical frameworks*; the examiner rewards their translation into a specific, boundary-aware administrative rule, not their recitation.

1. State the teaching precisely (verbatim where quoted).
2. Identify which values-institutions tension (see 01) it addresses.
3. Translate into one specific administrative rule or decision procedure.
4. Give a concrete governance example where the rule was/could be applied.
5. State the rule's own limitation, to demonstrate structural (not merely rhetorical) understanding.

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Which classical Indian text is cited by the 2nd ARC for an early structural (rather than purely moral) theory of official corruption?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Reconcile Kautilya's assumption that temptation is near-universal with Gandhi's emphasis on character - what does this imply for vigilance-system design?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** "The strength of a society is not in its laws, but in the morality of its people." Does this understate the ARC's own institutional diagnosis of corruption in India?

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion: `basic/02_Human-Values-and-Lessons-from-Leaders.md`.
- FACT: `01_Ethics-and-Human-Interface.md` - the values-institutions synthesis this file builds on.
- FACT: `06_Indian-Moral-Thinkers-and-Philosophers.md` - Kautilya, Gandhi, Vivekananda, Buddha in depth.
- FACT: `21_Protecting-Honest-Officials-and-Vigilance-Administration.md` - the surveillance/trust boundary this file flags.
- FACT: `Philosophy/paper-1/indian/Jainism.md` - Anekantavada and Syadvada in full philosophical depth.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md`.

- **Years represented:** 2020, 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-IV
- **Routed question demands:** 3

Semantic table split - Year

- **Year:** 2020
- **Paper:** GS-IV
- **Q:** 1
- **PYQ demand (neutral rendering):** (a) role of ethics and values in enhancing the three major components of Comprehensive National Power and social harmony; (b) education as pervasive tool for individual development and social transformation - NEP 2020
- **Directive / format:** Discuss / Examine · 10 + 10 marks · 150 words each
- **Source status:** Routed to owning Ethics topic; stem verified against official scan; OCR artifact resolved
- **Owner requirement:** Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
- **Year:** 2020
- **Paper:** GS-IV

- **Q: 5**
- **PYQ demand (neutral rendering):** (a) main factors for gender inequality in India and Savitribai Phule contribution; (b) internet expansion instilling cultural values in conflict with traditional values
- **Directive / format:** Discuss · 10 + 10 marks · 150 words each
- **Source status:** Routed to owning Ethics topic
- **Owner requirement:** Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
- **Year:** 2022
- **Paper:** GS-IV
- **Q: 3**
- **PYQ demand (neutral rendering):** (a) Potter Stewart on ethics vs right-to-do; (b) APJ Kalam on corruption-free nation; (c) Dalai Lama on success and sacrifice
- **Directive / format:** Discuss · 10 + 10 + 10 marks · 150 words each
- **Source status:** Routed to owning Ethics topic
- **Owner requirement:** Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- (a) role of ethics and values in enhancing the three major components of Comprehensive National Power and social harmony; (b) education as pervasive tool for individual development and social transformation - NEP 2020
- (a) main factors for gender inequality in India and Savitribai Phule contribution; (b) internet expansion instilling cultural values in conflict with traditional values
- (a) Potter Stewart on ethics vs right-to-do; (b) APJ Kalam on corruption-free nation; (c) Dalai Lama on success and sacrifice

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

EMBEDDED TWELVE-PANEL ASCII REVISION ATLAS

The panels compress the learning route without replacing the complete teaching and solved practice above.

ASCII PANEL 1/12 - 1. Where values come from and how they become character

CENTRAL FOCUS

1. Where values come from and how they become character

- [1] Values are enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile.
|
v
- [2] Family provides early models of honesty and care.
|
v
- [3] Schools translate ideals into repeated fair practice.
|
v
- [4] Culture and peers can reinforce or corrode values.
|
v
- [5] Leaders offer memorable examples rather than complete solutions.
|
v
- [6] Lived hardship can test and revise inherited commitments.
|
v
- [7] Institutions reward some conduct and discourage other conduct.
|
v
- [8] Internalisation is visible when conduct remains ethical unobserved.
|
v

VERDICT -> Values are socially formed, repeatedly tested, and never safely assumed to be fixed.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the opening mechanism for value-inculcation answers.

ASCII PANEL 2/12 - 2. Turning values into public-service choices

CENTRAL FOCUS

2. Turning values into public-service choices

- [1] Honesty requires accurate records rather than favourable figures.
|
v
- [2] Compassion requires fair access rather than discretionary favour.
|
v
- [3] Courage requires resisting improper pressure through lawful channels.
|
v
- [4] Self-discipline requires refusing temptation under discretion.
|
v
- [5] Duty requires timely and competent service to citizens.
|
v
- [6] Reasoned records make values reviewable in public office.
|
v
- [7] Procedures protect values when pressure becomes intense.
|
v
- [8] Citizen outcomes test whether ethical intent became public value.
|
v

VERDICT -> A value earns administrative meaning only when it changes a defensible decision.

ANSWER USE -> Convert any abstract value into a named administrative action.

ASCII PANEL 3/12 - 3. Gandhi: keeping means and ends ethically connected

CENTRAL FOCUS

3. Gandhi: keeping means and ends ethically connected

- [1] Politics without principles detaches power from public purpose.
|
v
[2] Wealth without work detaches gain from fair contribution.
|
v
[3] Pleasure or leisure without conscience detaches enjoyment from restraint.
|
v
[4] Knowledge without character detaches learning from responsibility.
|
v
[5] Commerce without morality detaches exchange from fairness.
|
v
[6] Science without humanity detaches capability from dignity.
|
v
[7] Worship without sacrifice detaches belief from ethical conduct.
|
v
[8] ARC prints leisure while the 1925 note uses pleasure.
|
v

VERDICT -> Test not merely whether an end was achieved, but whether its means respected conscience.

ANSWER USE -> Apply to procurement, data consent, political conduct, or target-driven governance.

ASCII PANEL 4/12 - 4. Learning courage and calm from Indian exemplars

CENTRAL FOCUS

4. Learning courage and calm from Indian exemplars

- [1] Vivekananda favours learning from others without becoming them.
|
v
[2] Adaptation preserves a useful reform while fitting local conditions.
|
v
[3] Sardar Patel's UPSC-attributed line joins faith to strength.
|
v
[4] Conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity.
|
v
[5] Thiruvalluvar values composure amid adversity.
|
v
[6] Equanimity improves assessment and communication during crisis.
|
v
[7] Calm leadership must still act decisively and lawfully.
|
v
[8] Quotation attribution must not be overstated without primary evidence.
|
v

VERDICT -> Learn openly, act capably, and remain composed without confusing calm with inaction.

ANSWER USE -> Use for reform adaptation, disaster leadership, and courage-under-pressure answers.

ASCII PANEL 5/12 - 5. Mahavir: many-sided truth and non-possession

CENTRAL FOCUS

5. Mahavir: many-sided truth and non-possession

- [1] Mahavir's five Mahavratas include Ahimsa and Satya.
|
v
- [2] Asteya rejects taking what is not rightfully due.
|
v
- [3] Brahmacharya is separately enumerated in Mahavir's tradition.
|
v
- [4] Aparigraha requires non-possessiveness and restraint.
|
v
- [5] Anekantavada treats complex truth-claims as many-sided.
|
v
- [6] Syadvada requires conditional and standpoint-aware assertion.
|
v
- [7] Consultation improves evidence before a public decision.
|
v
- [8] Many-sidedness does not cancel moral or legal judgement.
|
v

VERDICT -> Listen widely and restrain private gain, then decide with reasons.

ANSWER USE -> Apply to land, environment, conflict of interest, and pluralism questions.

ASCII PANEL 6/12 - 6. Kautilya and the design of corruption controls

CENTRAL FOCUS

6. Kautilya and the design of corruption controls

- [1] Officials handling money face temptation like honey on a tongue.
|
v
- [2] Concealed embezzlement resembles fish drinking water.
|
v
- [3] Opportunity and secrecy make character-only solutions inadequate.
|
v
- [4] Separation of duties reduces concentrated discretion.
|
v
- [5] Reconciliation and risk-based audit improve detectability.
|
v
- [6] Transparent criteria constrain arbitrary transfer and reward.
|
v
- [7] Wrongful accumulation requires due-process investigation.
|
v
- [8] Just wealth creation merits continuity and positive recognition.
|
v

VERDICT -> Vigilance should reduce opportunity while protecting and rewarding honest service.

ANSWER USE -> Build a balanced anti-corruption paragraph with systems and incentives.

ASCII PANEL 7/12 - 7. Duty without craving credit: Nishkama karma

CENTRAL FOCUS

7. Duty without craving credit: Nishkama karma

- [1] Nishkama karma requires action without attachment to personal fruit.
|
v
- [2] It preserves effort even when recognition is uncertain.
|
v
- [3] It requires concern for whether citizens receive the service.
|
v
- [4] It rejects personal credit as the purpose of public work.
|
v
- [5] It does not authorise indifference to outcomes.
|
v
- [6] It does not require compliance with unlawful orders.
|
v
- [7] It does not make chronic burnout an ethical ideal.
|
v
- [8] Fulfilment arises from meaningful and accountable service.
|
v

VERDICT -> Serve fully, measure public outcomes, and remain unattached to private reward.

ANSWER USE -> Use for duty, responsibility, fulfilment, and work-culture answers.

ASCII PANEL 8/12 - 8. Reform through education: Savitribai Phule and Kalam

CENTRAL FOCUS

8. Reform through education: Savitribai Phule and Kalam

- [1] Savitribai Phule co-founded the Bhide Wada girls' school in 1848.
|
v
- [2] Education attacks exclusion through durable access and institutions.
|
v
- [3] Gender equality needs safety, support and opportunity beyond slogans.
|
v
- [4] Kalam used a righteousness-to-peace ethical chain.
|
v
- [5] Kalam credited that chain to Sathya Sai Baba in 2007.
|
v
- [6] Personal integrity can influence family and civic conduct.
|
v
- [7] Individual virtue alone cannot prove national causation.
|
v
- [8] Institutional reform converts aspiration into sustained equality.
|
v

VERDICT -> Ethical transformation begins with persons but endures through inclusive institutions.

ANSWER USE -> Use for gender equality, education, social reform, and integrity answers.

ASCII PANEL 9/12 - 9. How to use a leader without hero-worship

CENTRAL FOCUS

9. How to use a leader without hero-worship

- [1] State the teaching precisely before applying it.
|
v
- [2] Identify the public value and competing duty involved.
|
v
- [3] Translate the teaching into a concrete decision rule.
|
v
- [4] Use a specific Indian administrative illustration.
|
v
- [5] Name the procedure that checks discretionary misuse.
|
v
- [6] Distinguish a source-grounded fact from analytical inference.
|
v
- [7] Acknowledge a provenance or contextual limitation where relevant.
|
v
- [8] Conclude with a qualified rather than absolute verdict.
|
v

VERDICT -> An exemplar guides judgement; it does not replace evidence, law, or institutional design.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the quality-control sequence for quotation and thinker answers.

ASCII PANEL 10/12 - 10. Writing quotation answers that earn GS-IV marks

CENTRAL FOCUS

10. Writing quotation answers that earn GS-IV marks

- [1] Restate the quotation's ethical core in one clear sentence.
|
v
- [2] Give only the brief context needed for the present question.
|
v
- [3] Translate the idea into a governance mechanism.
|
v
- [4] Show one Indian illustration doing analytical work.
|
v
- [5] Explain how the mechanism benefits citizens or public trust.
|
v
- [6] State the limit, trade-off, or attribution caution.
|
v
- [7] Do not replace analysis with a leader's biography.
|
v
- [8] Close with an ethical rule joined to institutional safeguards.
|
v

VERDICT -> Quotation questions reward applied ethics, not memory or reverence.

ANSWER USE -> Follow this sequence for every 10-mark quotation response.

ASCII PANEL 11/12 - 11. MCQ and trap repair

CENTRAL FOCUS

11. MCQ and trap repair

[1] Internalisation is not conduct displayed only for appraisal.

|

v

[2] Values are broader than object-specific attitudes.

|

v

[3] Anekantavada is not moral relativism or indecision.

|

v

[4] Aparigraha is not neglect of legitimate public spending.

|

v

[5] Nishkama karma is not indifference to citizen outcomes.

|

v

[6] Kautilya is not a warrant for arbitrary surveillance.

|

v

[7] Gandhi's list has a pleasure and leisure textual variation.

|

v

[8] UPSC attribution does not by itself prove primary provenance.

|

v

VERDICT -> Close options fail when they turn a qualified ethical concept into an absolute claim.

ANSWER USE -> Use for prelims elimination and final answer self-audit.

ASCII PANEL 12/12 - 12. PYQ and answer synthesis

CENTRAL FOCUS

12. PYQ and answer synthesis

[1] 2024 tested Vivekananda, Patel and Kant through present-context translation.

|

v

[2] 2025 tested Thiruvalluvar, William James and Vivekananda quotations.

|

v

[3] 2025 also tested Mahavir's teachings and devotion to duty.

|

v

[4] Use traceable provenance when the owner provides it.

|

v

[5] Treat disputed wording as a UPSC attribution rather than a primary citation.

|

v

[6] Pair Gandhi's character warning with Kautilya's control design.

|

v

[7] Pair Mahavir's consultation with a lawful recorded decision.

|

v

[8] Pair Mission Karmayogi learning reach with conduct-based safeguards.

|

v

VERDICT -> The highest-scoring answer moves from idea to mechanism, example, qualification and verdict.

ANSWER USE -> Use as the final revision map before PYQ practice.

ONE-PAGE CONCEPT GRID

Concept / thinker	Exam-ready formulation
Value formation is social and revisable	Values are enduring beliefs about what is desirable that are transmitted through family, education, culture, peers, role models and lived experience; they can be strengthened or corroded by repeated institutional incentives rather than being permanently fixed at birth.
Internalisation differs from performance	Value internalisation means that a value guides conduct even when no one is watching, whereas value performance displays approved conduct mainly for appraisal, publicity or fear of sanction; the former is more reliable under discretion and pressure.
Values are broader than attitudes	Values are relatively enduring beliefs about what is worthwhile across situations, while attitudes are object-specific evaluations; value education therefore develops judgement and habits, not merely a favourable response to a particular policy or person.
Mission Karmayogi is an institutional channel	Mission Karmayogi's NPCSCB approach links civil-service capacity building to functional and behavioural competencies, a citizen-government interface, a shift from rules to roles, and iGOT learning; it institutionalises learning but cannot by itself prove ethical internalisation.
Gandhi's social sins join means to ends	The Seven Social Sins published and endorsed by Gandhi warn against separating power, wealth, pleasure, knowledge, commerce, science and worship from their ethical restraints; their administrative force lies in testing whether apparently successful ends were pursued through principled means.
Gandhi list provenance needs care	ARC Box 2.8 reproduces the Seven Social Sins from Gandhi's Young India context, but the 22 October 1925 note presented the list as sent by a correspondent and uses 'pleasure without conscience' where the ARC prints 'leisure without conscience'; answers should not overclaim authorship or textual uniformity.
Vivekananda supports adaptation, not imitation	Vivekananda's traceable 2024 quotation advocates learning what is good from others while absorbing it in one's own way; in administration it supports contextual adaptation of useful institutions, not either blind copying or reflexive rejection of external learning.
Faith requires capacity and resolve	The 2024 UPSC-attributed Sardar Patel proposition joins faith with strength: ethical conviction needs competence, courage and organised capacity to accomplish public work; because no primary Patel speech or letter source is traced, the answer should analyse the stated idea without manufacturing a citation.
Thiruvalluvar teaches active equanimity	The Thiruvalluvar quotation tested in 2025 conveys equanimity in adversity: composure prevents panic from amplifying a crisis, but it does not excuse passivity; it is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623 rather than a named historic translation.
William James provenance and usable idea	The 2025 line about altering life by altering attitudes is widely attributed to William James but is not traceable to his writings and was popularised by Norman Vincent Peale; the answer may discuss conscious attitude change while clearly avoiding a fabricated James citation.

Concept / thinker	Exam-ready formulation
Law needs social morality but not replacement	The 2025 UPSC-attributed Vivekananda proposition that societal strength rests in morality rather than laws usefully stresses internalised compliance, yet law, due process and institutions remain necessary safeguards; the wording is not traceable to the Complete Works and must not be treated as a verified primary quotation.
Anekantavada is not moral relativism	Mahavir's Anekantavada and Syadvada express many-sidedness and conditional predication: complex truth-claims require humility and structured consideration of standpoints, but the doctrines do not mean that every claim is equally valid or that public authorities may avoid justified decisions.

CORE REVISION SPINE

- **Aparigraha translates into probity:** Aparigraha, non-possessiveness among Mahavir's five Mahavratas, supports a public ethic of non-attachment to office-derived gain, conflict-of-interest control and resistance to nepotism; it does not demand indifference to legitimate public resources or personal responsibility.
- **Kautilya identifies opportunity and concealment:** The Arthashastra passages quoted in ARC Annexure-I(2) use the honey and fish analogies to show that officials handling public money face temptation and concealment; this is a structural account of corruption that calls for auditable controls, detection and fair incentives, not character sermons alone.
- **Kautilya is not surveillance alone:** Kautilya's ARC-cited account pairs action against wrongful accumulation with permanence for officials who increase public wealth in just ways; a modern translation therefore balances rule-bound vigilance, rewards and protection of honest officials rather than normalising punitive or arbitrary surveillance.
- **Nishkama karma rejects personal attachment:** Nishkama karma means performing one's duty without attachment to personal reward, credit or fruit; it requires conscientious effort and concern for public outcomes, not indifference to whether a programme succeeds or a citizen is harmed.
- **Duty joins responsibility and fulfilment:** Devotion to duty gives a civil servant responsibility for timely, fair and competent action and can yield personal fulfilment through meaningful service; it cannot legitimise burnout, illegal orders or a self-righteous refusal to learn from affected citizens.
- **Savitribai Phule models institution-building:** Savitribai Phule's work with Jyotirao Phule in co-founding the Bhide Wada girls' school in Pune in 1848 shows that gender inequality is confronted through durable institutions, access to education and support for excluded groups, not sentiment alone.
- **Kalam's chain is attributed with care:** A.P.J. Abdul Kalam used and endorsed a chain linking righteousness in the heart to peace in the world, while crediting it in his 2007 European Parliament address to Sathya Sai Baba; it illustrates a bottom-up ethical aspiration, not an empirically proven single-cause model of governance.
- **Exemplars need contextual translation:** Leader-based ethics is useful when a teaching is translated into a specific decision rule, Indian illustration and institutional safeguard; it becomes an exemplar fallacy when a revered name substitutes for evidence, ignores competing duties or pretends that personal virtue alone settles a complex case.
- **Quotation answers test translation:** A strong GS-IV quotation answer states the core idea, briefly situates it, translates it into a present administrative mechanism, supplies a concrete Indian illustration, acknowledges a relevant limitation or provenance caution, and closes with a qualified ethical verdict rather than a biography.
- **Values and institutions must work together:** Character-centred lessons such as Gandhi's and structural lessons such as Kautilya's are complementary: internalised values guide conduct where rules cannot observe everything, while transparent procedures, incentives and accountability reduce opportunities for values to be overwhelmed by discretion and pressure.
- **Brahmacharya requires textual precision:** Mahavir's five Mahavratas are Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya and Aparigraha; Jain tradition distinguishes Parshvanatha's four restraints from Mahavir's five, with Brahmacharya separately enumerated rather than being an ethical idea demonstrably invented by Mahavir.

- **Competency scale is not conduct proof:** As of 6 February 2026, Mission Karmayogi's iGOT ecosystem had 1.49 crore users, 4,342 courses, 7.26 crore completions and 23 languages; these dated figures show learning reach, not a verified general APAR linkage or automatic improvement in ethical conduct.

SOURCE AND ATTRIBUTION DISCIPLINE

Use the local Basic owner as the controlling source. Gandhi's 1925 list was published and endorsed by Gandhi but presented as sent by a correspondent; its original wording has 'pleasure' where ARC Box 2.8 prints 'leisure'. The 2024 Patel line, 2025 William James line, and 2025 Vivekananda law-morality line are UPSC attributions not traced to primary sources in the owner. Thiruvalluvar's 2025 wording is a modern paraphrase of Tirukkural 623. Kalam used the righteousness-to-peace chain while crediting Sathya Sai Baba. Do not turn any caution into a fabricated citation.

ANSWER SPINE

1. Define the precise ethical concept or teaching.
2. State a qualified thesis rather than a moral slogan.
3. Explain the causal or decision-making mechanism.
4. Add one specific Indian administrative illustration.
5. Test the strongest limitation or attribution caveat.
6. End with a practical, institution-aware verdict.

Rapid recall: Values are learned through family, school, culture, peers, exemplars and experience; internalisation survives absence of audit. Gandhi tests means-ends separation; Vivekananda supports adapted learning; Patel joins conviction to capacity; Thiruvalluvar joins calm to action; Mahavir supplies Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya, Aparigraha, Anekantavada and Syadvada; Kautilya joins temptation controls to incentives; Nishkama karma rejects attachment to personal reward, not responsibility for outcomes. Savitribai Phule demonstrates institution-building for equality. Mission Karmayogi supplies a role-and-competency training channel, not proof of conduct. Answer spine: idea -> mechanism -> Indian illustration -> limitation -> verdict.